PART 2 · GLOSSARY

Glossary of freelance business terms

Short plain definitions.

Term	Meaning
A/B test	Comparing two versions to see which performs better.
Applicant tracking system	Software employers use to filter resumes.
Billable hours	Hours you can charge a client for.
Buffer	Extra time or money allowed for the unexpected.
Case study	A story of one project with approved facts.
Change request	A written, priced request to add or change scope.
Deliverable	A specific item handed to the client.
Deposit	Part of the price paid before work starts.
Invoice	A bill with number, date, amount and due date.
KPI	A number used to track progress towards a goal.
Kill fee	A payment owed if the client ends the project early.
Milestone	A checkpoint tied to a deliverable and a payment.
NDA	Non-disclosure agreement about confidential information.
Net 30	Payment due 30 days after the invoice date.
Niche	A narrow group of customers or a narrow service.
Outreach	Contacting a prospect who has not asked to hear from you.
Portfolio	Evidence of your work with problem, action and result.
Productised service	A service sold as a fixed package with a fixed price.
Proposal	A message that offers to do the work and explains how.
Retainer	A recurring monthly arrangement for agreed work or hours.
Revision	A round of changes to a deliverable.
SOP	Standard operating procedure: written steps for a task.
Scope	What work is and is not included in a project.
Scope creep	Work growing beyond the written scope.
Subcontractor	Someone you hire to do part of a client's work.

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